

# What does ‘small numbers’ mean?

The 2026 hunting quotas, checked against Malta’s own legal benchmark

## THE CLAIM

*“Under strictly supervised conditions ... in small numbers”*

Directive 2009/147/EC, Article 9(1)(c)

Malta’s 2026 quotas: 2,400 Quail · 1,500 Turtle-doves

The benchmark is a statutory model, not a count of birds migrating over Malta.

## VERDICT

# NOT SUBSTANTIATED

*The quota maths fits;  
implementation is open.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY  
SUPPORTED

NOT  
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

## MAIN RESULTS

### 99.3%

Quail quota / benchmark

2,400 quota against the regulation's  
2,416-bird 1% benchmark.

### 59.8%

Turtle-dove quota / benchmark

1,500 quota against the regulation's  
2,510-bird 1% benchmark.

### Declining

Turtle-dove context

WBRU reports a continuing  
central-eastern flyway decline; latest  
Article 12 data were provisional.

### 2025

Latest outcome report

WBRU records 1,336 patrols, 909  
spot-checks and 19 detected offences  
for 2025.

### Not yet

2026 supervision

No 2026 season outcome report was  
listed in the WBRU archive at the 2  
October review cut-off.

## FAIR TO SAY

Both quotas are below the legal  
mortality benchmark. That confirms  
the formula was followed on the  
Government's inputs; it does not  
prove sustainability or strict  
supervision in practice.

## WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ Publish the 2026 outcome and enforcement data.

☐ Show the final population inputs and mortality method.

☐ Publish the Ornis minutes and vote.

☐ Release and independently validate the FKNK survey  
results.